

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a local newspaper:

Learning from little Iceland

In recent years, Iceland, a tiny country of just 350,000 people has become surprisingly successful in international football. Ten years ago, they did not even rank in the top 100 of the FIFA World Rankings, but have now jumped up to 22nd place, drawing 1-1 with Argentina at the World Cup and beating England before that.

The Hong Kong Football Association (HKFA) sees Iceland as a great example of what could be done to improve local football. Both Hong Kong and Iceland face similar problems such as the lack of locations to play the sport and a lack of players. The difference lies in the fact that Iceland has invested money in building playing facilities and in training coaches.

Hoping to learn from Iceland's example, the HKFA will send representatives to Iceland to learn how to improve. Perhaps the most exciting part of all is that the Hong Kong youth team will travel to Iceland for ten days to play, allowing our young players to experience Western football and its culture.

Critics of the \$1 million project argue that such a scheme cannot solve the real problems of Hong Kong football and sport in general. Those in charge of sport in Hong Kong are often accused of not having the interests of the athletes at heart. The head of the Olympic committee came under fierce criticism in the 2014 Winter Olympics for taking six officials to the Olympics but no doctor for the competing athlete.

Your class is doing a project on 'The Importance of International Sport'. Your group has been asked to discuss the development of sport in Hong Kong. You may want to talk about:

- whether Hong Kong is successful in international sport
- whether sport is important to Hong Kong people
- whether Hong Kong can learn from other countries to improve sports
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Can training improve sport skills?
2. Why do many Hong Kong teenagers stop doing sport?
3. Do women have the same opportunities to play sport as men?
4. Why are some countries more successful than others at sport?
5. Are attitudes to sport changing in Hong Kong?
6. Is there too much emphasis on sport nowadays?
7. Will Hong Kong ever become famous for sport?
8. Can sport teach you life skills?